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CHRISTMAS VALLEY
PROPERTY OWNERS

Christmas Valley GAZETTE

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CHRISTMAS VALLEY, OREGON

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AUG. - SEPT., 1967

PERRY MASON AUTHOR EXPLORES IN CHRISTMAS VALLEY AREA



REUB LONG, RIGHT, shows Erle Stanley Gardner and Moyne DeShazer fossil bones of prehistoric horse which roamed the area before the Ice Age.

Erle Stanley Gardner, the famed author of the Perry Mason detective novels and other stories, spent eight days recently exploring Lake County's Oregon Desert with R. A. and Eleanor Long of Fort Rock as guides. Gardner was accompanied by a group of associates with whom he makes exploration trips in the southwest and Mexico.

They made their base camp at the Lost Forest and explored as far south as Foley Creek and out to the ice caves, Fossil Lake; the sand dunes and other areas of the desert region. Several fossil specimens were found, Long reported.

Gardner and some members of his party, including Jack and Coral Pepper, publishers of Desert Magazine, were interested in the legend of the Blue Bucket Mine, especially the Lois A. Pierce version of the lost wagon train of 1845. Various researchers have attributed a number of routes to this wagon train which is

supposed to have discovered a fabulous deposit of free gold called "The Blue Bucket Mine," and while most students of the old stories believe the wagon train went up through the John Day country (and that the "Blue Bucket" was later rediscovered in 1860 when the John Day gold fields were found) the Pierce version brings the train into Lake County through the Blue Joint Lake area to Foley Creek and north from there. Mrs. Pierce, of Hoodport, Wash., contends the Blue Bucket was found at Foley Creek, but no gold has been found there and she holds that in records of the wagon train there is no contention that a lot of gold was located . . . that the legend of the mine itself was mostly legend.

The party traced out parts of the Old Immigrant Trail which passes through the Lost Forest, Long said, and also part of the Yreka-John Day trail which was north of the Lost Forest.

The sand dunes were explored by sand buggies which are manufactured by one member of the Gardner party, and of which they had seven with them.

Mr. and Mrs. Pepper gathered material for articles which will appear in their Desert Magazine.

There were 16 in the party, including Gardner, Mr. and Mrs. Long, Mr. and Mrs. Pepper, Mr. and Mrs. Sam Hicks, Mr. and Mrs. J. W. Black, Mr. and Mrs. Dick DeShazer, Mr. and Mrs. Bruce Barren, Art Bernard, Jeanne Bethel and the cook, Albert Miller.

Gardner is noted for his exploration trips and for his "Court of Last Resort" as well as for his writing. He writes most of his own name, but also uses the pseudonym A. A. Fair.



All of us are so pleased with the fine job Bob Lloyd is doing hosting the fine golf course at Christmas Valley that I have asked him to sit in for me writing this month's column.

Golfing here at Christmas Valley picked up considerably during July and August what with the beautiful weather and all. A Lakeview day was held on Sunday, August 7 and proved very satisfactory. The golfers had sandwiches, refreshments, and one of Atches fine chicken dinners. They were also rewarded with nice trophies for low net and gross golf scores. They were a real golfing group and it did your pro good to see them on the putting green until midnight. Lights for this event were provided by several automobiles.

The tournament winners were: Ed Hall, low gross and Carter Fetsch, low net; in the men's round. Bess Hall, low gross and Teresa

Fetsch, low net, captured the gal's trophies.

There have been several couples from California the past few weeks that had never played golf before. Most of them took a lesson or two and then went out on the course. One of these, Keith Bateman, after one lesson on the driving range, took a course playing lesson with yours truly and shot for his very first nine holes an amazing fifty four. His wife, Lee, caught some very nice trout while hubby was shooting his astounding round. All of our resident players handicaps went down in August and with some handicap tournaments coming up I can still hear their screaming. We have the course in its best condition ever at the present time and all first time golfers here have said they will definitely return. Low nine for men this year is 37 and for women, 47, thus attesting to a real challenging course. New golf balls are given by the Pro shop to anyone breaking course records for nine or eighteen holes and for residents, non-residents, or professionals both in men and women play. So far the pro shop has given away almost two dozen balls. So let's have at it.

'Fish Burping' Just a Part Of Fish Farming -- Jim Driscoll

It wasn't too long ago that the rainbow trout that just made a shambles of your line in Christmas Valley Lake was an almost transparent "thing" in the concrete rearing tanks of Jim Driscoll's Prairie Springs Trout Farm, in Grant County. But before that trout put on all that muscle he — and Jim Driscoll — had survived a number of crises. For instance:

The trout were dying. Jim and Keety Driscoll were desperate. Jim picked one up, stroked its stomach and it burped. He tossed it into a tank and it swam away briskly.

He grabbed another. So did Keety. Again and again they stroked trout stomachs, the trout burped and promptly felt better.

"Like burping a baby," said Keety, who had burped four of their own.

The trout farmers had survived another crisis.

This one was caused by feeding the trout too soon before transporting them in a tank truck. But crises are part of the life of a trout farmer, starting with one round-the-clock during the hatching. Even a slight contamination in the tank then could wipe out the just-hatched fish.

Many Crises Survived

The Driscolls have survived many crises in their seven years

of trout farming. "Mostly," says Jim "by improvising. This is a business of improvisation."

The raising of trout is a business chiefly because a lot of ranchers want to be able to go fishing in their farm ponds. For \$20 they can buy 1,000 rainbows an inch and a half long, dump them in their own ponds, and the next year with no care at all can be catching trout up to a foot long.

Instant Fishing

Or if they want instant fishing, they can buy trout eight inches and longer for 70 cents a pound—roughly 35 cents for an eight-inch fish.

If they want to start with little ones they can pick them up in (Continued on Page 2)

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Schedule of Christmas Valley Events

CHURCH: Sunday School every Sunday at 10 a.m. Church services at 11 a.m., first Sunday of month. Non-denominational services by American Sunday School Union, John Burtlehaus in charge.

DANCES: Square dances, Friday nights. Rec. Bldg.

CARDS: Cards and Bingo, Wednesday nights. Rec. Bldg.

MOVIES: Friday nights.

AUGUST: Pro-Am Golf Tournament.

SEPT. 5: Family Vacation Package ends.

BAY PROPERTY OWNERS: Meet at San Jose I.E.S. Hall every third Wednesday, 7:30 p.m.

Trout Farming

(Continued from Page 1)
milk cans. If they want larger ones, they can get delivery by tank truck.

The Driscolls' Prairie Springs trout farm just east of Dayville in Grant County is one of many such enterprises. It is larger than most in Oregon, smaller than a number in Idaho and Washington.

Water Decides Limit

"It's water that limits you," says Jim. "You've got to have a place with a lot of water."

The Driscolls' farm covers 500 hillside acres above the John Day River. It is dotted with springs and artesian wells with a total flow of around 1,000 gallons a minute.

"We've had 350,000 trout in our tanks at one time," says Jim, "and we can expand. But we don't have enough water to get to a million or a million and a half as some of the Idaho trout farms can."

He starts with eggs, flown in mostly from a Soap Lake, Wash., trays in a large building filled hatchery. They are placed in with troughs and tanks and running water.

When the fish hatch, they are fed a powdered meal up to five times a day, and when they reach an inch and a half in length — in some six weeks they are netted and put in outdoor tanks. These are concrete structure some 30 feet long and 5 to 6 feet wide, sunk into the ground and placed at successively lower levels on the hillside. Water from the springs flows down from one to the other, giving a brisk current on its run through the tanks to the John Day River.

Birds Eat Fish

Often a kingfisher or a blue heron stops for a meal or two — "They are protected," says Jim with some annoyance — but the big hazard to the fish is pollution.

When something goes wrong and the fish begin to die, Jim checks his sanitation work, cleans the tanks and considers whether there has been a change in the feed that might have caused the trouble.

"This is a high risk business," says Jim. "One batch of bad feed can wipe you out."

"You could learn all these
(Continued On Page 4)



SEVEN COUNTIES REPRESENTED AS STUDENTS SEE CHRISTMAS VALLEY

Thirty-five students accompanied by their advisors, rode into Christmas Valley by bus the evening of August 7. These students represent seven southwestern counties in Oregon; namely, Lake, Klamath, Jackson, Jefferson, Coos, Douglas and Curry Counties. Only gifted students in their high schools are chosen for the six weeks residential summer school work called "Project Prometheus" and field trips take them to such places as Fossil Lake, Malheur and Steens Mountains, Hole in the Ground, Ft. Rock Cave, etc.

They study water problems, geologic formations, fossils, etc. These are all intellectually gifted teenagers who will be seniors in their various high schools this coming fall term.

This is the only like project in the United States, coming under the Intermediate Education District group. Their teachers and advisors on this trip include Ron Lamb, teacher from southern Oregon College, Bob Bayley, teacher from Crater High School and Marcella Chichvaras, principal of Canyonville, Oregon, High School.

Two students from nearby Pais-

Reconstructed Thompson Reservoir Campground Again Open

The morning of Saturday, June 10, the Recreation Maintenance Crew on the Silver Lake District took down the sign at the entrance to Thompson Reservoir Campground which reads, "Closed for the Season — Rehabilitation in Progress."

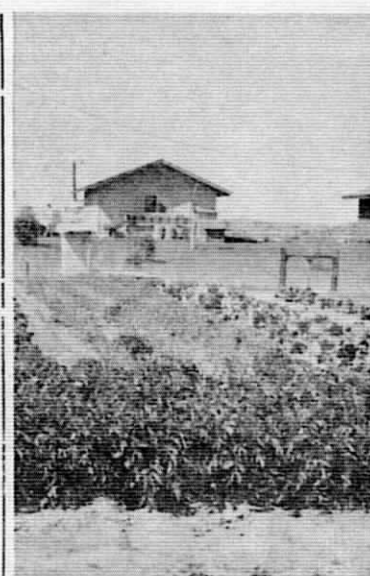
LONG CLOSED

Ranger Paul Stenkamp announced that June 10, 1967, marked the official opening to the public of this perennially favorite camping spot. Closed for the past 10 months, the site has been reconstructed "from the ground up!" and now offers improved roads and parking facilities, individual campsites, a picnic area, and a boat launch constructed in cooperation with Lake County.

FEE AREA

This area is one of the few in Southeastern Oregon selected for designation as a fee area under the Land and Water Conservation Act. Collection of fees under either the \$7.00 Annual Permit or the \$1.00 Daily Permit will begin on July 1, 1967.

Further information is available at the Ranger Station in Silver Lake.



GARDENS ABOUND IN Christmas Valley.

Gardens abound in Christmas Valley

This was a wonderful summer for gardeners in Christmas Valley. The other day we noted a big bouquet in the grocery store. It had roses, geraniums, honeysuckle, sweet peas, begonias, asters, alyssum, among other things, and we asked where they came from. Owner Connie Baert proudly said they were all from her front yard flower garden at their home which is on the edge of the golf course.

Catherine Olander kept the lodge supplied with flowers this summer from her garden, and they do have a beautiful yard at their home.

Ted Schott has his usual wonderfully prolific garden and many visitors drive down by their house just to get a glimpse of those cabbages which were actually too large to put in the refrigerator unless cut in half. The Schotts will eat well this winter from their store of frozen beets, spinach, peas, etc.

Clark Bomar could be seen giving away big buckets of strawberries from his garden and were they good!

Helen Byam said Bob had grown so many Chinese peas that she was having to learn to make more oriental dishes in order to use them all.

This summer one could almost see the various trees planted in the townsite and in the homeowners' yards growing by leaps and bounds. The warm weather and good soil makes us all feel that we are truly gardeners.

Mercy Flights Prepared For Second Year

Lake County Mercy Flights has made 30 emergency air ambulance flights from July 22 of last year to the present, the board of directors was told Monday, June 12, by the president, Choc Shelton, at the corporation's annual meeting at the Conn & Lynch law offices.

Shelton was re-elected president, Dr. William Strieby, vice-president, and T. R. Conn, secretary. The board elected Dick Lennie treasurer and Jim Lampkins, assistant treasurer. Other board members are Carter Fetsch and Alan Withers.

Membership

Shelton said the flights were made as far south as Phoenix, Ariz., and north as far as Portland, with many to points in between. Most of the patients were members, who can fly a maximum of 400 miles without charge, but Mercy Flights realized \$2200 income from non-members who are charged \$1 per mile.

Membership is now about 1025, and with the annual payment date coming up on August 1, renewal payments are being received at the Chamber of Commerce office at the rate of 25 to 35 per day. Initial membership and dues for a year is \$20, and the subsequent annual fee is \$10. New memberships, now restricted to Lake County, are coming in almost every day.

Top Shape

About 100 hours flying time has been put on the plane, and it is in first class condition with new radio, de-icing equipment and other improvements. A hangar for the plane has been built at the airport, and no major expenses are seen for the future.

SAVE THAT MILK CARTON

The camper or picnicker can save extra utensils when he plans pancakes or scrambled eggs by putting the ingredients in a cardboard milk carton and shaking — top closed, of course. After use, the carton burns wonderfully in the fire.

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CHRISTMAS VALLEY, OREGON

Golf Course Big Hit With Visitors



"KATE" JOKERS RIDES golf cart driven by Al Baert for her third visit to Christmas Valley.



PAT AND VIVIAN setting up the shot for Stu Martin.



PAT CRIVELLONE AND Vivian Swindley "heckling" Mel Brown's golf game.

GOLF CART TOUR OF COURSE

Ted Schott's mother, Mrs. Alberta Schott and Grandmother "Kate" Jokers from Panorama City, California, paid their third annual visit to Christmas Valley recently. Kate will be celebrating her 90th birthday this month, but nothing like birthdays slows her down.

This summer she enjoyed viewing the golf course in an electric golf cart with Al Baert. She

changed places and rode back with her grandson Ted, possibly because she had heard rumors of Al upsetting a golf cart while playing the course at Salishan last summer.

Mrs. Jokers is an avid baseball fan and even though now living in Southern California she has yet to transfer her allegiance from the Cleveland Indians to the Dodgers.

TV PERSONALITIES "GOLF" IT UP

A gay party of vacationers from Seattle, Washington spent a week-end at Christmas Valley recently.

From the "Stu Martin Show," a television show in Seattle, came Stu Martin, Vivian Swindley and Pat Crivellone. On the show, Miss Swindley is known as "Miss Early Date" and Miss Crivellone as "Miss Late Date."

After a full weekend of golfing

and fishing they were really singing their praises of Christmas Valley loudly.

Even though the girls didn't know how to play golf they still had fun "hecking" Mel Brown and the other fellows playing.

Stu proudly displayed his catch of fish to everyone who would look at it.

Oregon's Tourists Income Shows Gain of \$2.2. Mollion

Income from Oregon's tourist industry climbed to a record high of \$252,700,000. Visitors to the state spent more than \$2.2 million more than they did in 1965 for food, lodging, recreation, car expenses and other items related to travel, the Highway Department report showed.

A survey was taken at 17 station along the state's borders of out-of-state motorists. In addition, estimates were made of visitors traveling by train, plane or bus, and persons on business trips who used travel facilities.

The automobile survey showed the estimated number of motoring visitors up to 6.5 million, compared to 5.8 million for 1965, with their total expenditures up more than \$3.2 million.

Record High

An influx of visitors from the south brought more Californians to the state than there were Oregonians, according to figures released by the Oregon State Highway Department. The report of 1966 activities showed 2,863,000 visitors to Oregon from California. Oregon's latest population figures show 1,999,780 as residents of the state.

WALKER TRIBE

During the third week of July Bruce and Myrie Walker of Ventura spent their vacation on their 5 acre tract in Christmas Valley. This has been the third year they have spent some time here dry camping on their property and look forward each year to the quiet and peacefulness of the high desert. The clear sky, bright shining stars, and the howl of the coyote, the breeze whispering through the sagebrush all add to the charm of the valley.

This year, however, the babble of many voices (including 4 dogs) were to be heard. By the end of the week of July 21 many members of the family had come to Christmas Valley for a reunion. For some, it was the first time in 10 years for being together. It was son Doug's second visit to Christmas Valley. With camper, trailer, and tents, they made quite a settlement.

Converging on Christmas Valley were: Mr. and Mrs. Jim Prater (daughter, Lynnett, Sandra, Tommy, and Steven Prater of Missoula, Montana. Mr. and Mrs. Ray Olson (daughter), Laura, Russell, Debbie, and Raider Olson of Missoula, Montana. Mr. and Mrs. Douglas Walker (son), Carol and Malinda Walker of Springfield, Oregon. Mrs. Gladys Andle (Mrs. Doug Walker's mother of Springfield). Mr. and Mrs. Robert Walker (brother), of Portland, Oregon. Mr. and Mrs. Clifford Prout (sister), of Portland, Oregon.

A great time was had by all. Bruce and Myrie plan to start building on their land in the near future and will be moving to Christmas Valley to stay in a few months.



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IN AND ABOUT . . .

Christmas Valley

Weekend visitors at the Gordon Goeres home were Mr. and Mrs. J. R. Friend and children. Mr. and Mrs. Harold Vansickle of Eugene; Mr. and Mrs. Robert Bliss, and Mr. and Mrs. Richard Goe of Seattle.

Golfers coming from Burns, Lakeview, Bend, Paisley and Silver Lake participated in the golf tournament July 16. They reported having a wonderful weekend here.

David Goeres returned this week from visiting his grandmother, Mrs. Florence Mitchell, at her summer home on Puget Sound.

We are happy to have Mrs. Owen Holmes home again after a long stay in the hospital.

Chuck Calcotte is home on leave from the Navy. He is stationed in San Francisco.

Mr. and Mrs. Ed Cowles and sons of Portland were here to visit Mrs. Cowles' parents, Mr. and Mrs. Jerry Emery.

Bud Wolocoff of Westminister, B.C. is visiting Mr. and Mrs. Dale Barton for a month. Bud is a nephew of Mrs. Barton.

Andy Plano, Jerry Emery and Charlie Western were three local firemen who attended a school of instruction for firemen in Klamath Falls on August 12.

Captain and Mrs. F. Warren and two children of Sacramento are here for a week of camping on their property.

Kathy Davis of Paisley, Mrs. G. Goeres and Linda went to Eugene Wednesday so the girls could do some shopping before school begins.

Mr. and Mrs. Larry Hall and children came from Alturas to visit Mrs. Hall's parents, Mr. and Mrs. Austin McClister.

Mrs. Gordon Goeres and children returned home from several days vacation in Western Washington.

Mr. and Mrs. Don Corum and sons of Bend were here to visit the Al Baerts last weekend.

Mr. and Mrs. W. T. Hamilton of Yucaipa, Calif., were guests at the H. Gustafson home. The Hamiltons are former residents of Christmas Valley.

Jean Weber of Fort Rock, who has been a waitress at the Lodge, left Friday for Paris, France. She will attend college there for the coming school year.

Mrs. Barbara Sims and children of Tokatee were weekend guests of her parents, Mr. and Mrs. John Casad.

Frank Hernandez of the Los Angeles area is visiting friends here for several days. Frank lived here two years ago and and drove school bus to Paisley.

Catherine and Chris Piaggia and Ann Goeres returned August 3 from a six day stay at Fir Point Bible Camp near Medford. They reported a wonderful time but glad to return to the sage and sand country.

Mrs. Jerry Emery was in Portland for three days this week. She had a checkup following her open heart surgery and visited her daughter and family, the Ed Cowles.

Mrs. Wes Ladbury and children returned Tuesday from Long Beach, Calif. They went down to attend the wedding of Ladbury's daughter, Judy.

Most of the linemen have left

the area now who have been working on the second phase of the intertie.

Mr. and Mrs. W. Thomas were in Portland last weekend.

J. Arthur Duff of Vancouver, B.C. is spending a week at his Desert Inn Motel here.

Mrs. Calvin Young, Debbie, and Delores have returned home from South Dakota.

Billy Plumb has returned from Michigan from Army Reserve Training for two weeks.

Mrs. Curt Weaver returned home from a visit in Texas.

Mr. and Mrs. Dell Swearingen have left to prepare for his fall job.

Mr. and Mrs. C. G. Vickerman and Norman Christensen salmon fished at Charleston this weekend.

Barbara McAlister of Fort Rock, spent the weekend with Jan Dunn.

Visitors in the valley for the last couple of weeks were Mr. and Mrs. Delbert Black of San Leandro. They have planted a crop on their acreage and are eagerly awaiting the time they can move up for good.

Mr. and Mrs. Mel Brown had their son, Bill and wife Nancy and three children: Mathew, Carol and Maria visit them for a weekend recently. Bill works for the Game Commission at a fish hatchery near Roseburg, Oregon.

The Byams had as their guests for a weekend the Dick Schafers of Portland. They attended the Lakeview Roundup while visiting here.

The weekend of September 23 and 24 saw the cowboys assembled once again at the Christmas Valley Dude Ranch grounds. Sponsored by the Lake County Roping Club and the Christmas Valley Rodeo Club. There were two days of team roping and barrel racing with prizes and buckles awarded to the winners. There was a Junior and Senior Jackpot each day. Roping started at 12 noon each day. Buck Muser of Lakeview was the announcer. A good crowd of both buckaroos and spectators turned out for this event.

School buses are rolling again from Christmas Valley. Every morning just about 7:30, the "big" bus starts off to Paisley High School, with Betty Goeres as driver. Betty picks up more than 30 students on her trip to Paisley each morning, and 16 of these are from Christmas Valley.

A little later each morning, the smaller bus leaves the lodge, headed for Ft. Rock School. Gloria Piazza is driver of this bus and she carries a total of 37 children to school. 31 of these are from Christmas Valley.

Melvin Brown, Jr., better known as "Butch" to his friends, was married August 19 at the base chapel at Alemendorf Air Base in Anchorage, Alaska. Melvin is the younger son of Mr. and Mrs. Mel Brown of Christmas Valley. His bride was the former Barbara Deshler also of Anchorage. Butch is Airman First Class and will be stationed in Alaska until next July.



"BIG" UNCLE JOHNNIE McClister on pony "Sunday"



GRANDFATHERS DELIGHT — DELORES and Cindy Hamett on new ponies.

TROUT FARM . . .

(Continued from Page 2)

things by going to school and the best place is the University of Washington as you might expect. But I learned the hard way; by trying it."

He is a spare, weatherbeaten man who grew up in New Hampshire but with his eyes on the West. His first chance came in picking a college. He chose the University of Oregon, but after two years entered the Navy for World War II and did not go back. Instead, he returned home to Manchester, N.H., and the family cigar business.

He quickly decided that was not for him and as he considered what to do he got to thinking, quite by chance, about raising trout. He learned how he could by talking with Eastern fish hatcherymen and decided to come

back to Oregon, where he had met and married Keety — then Marguerite Campbell of Portland.

Their hunt for the right place for a trout farm took more than a year and it was a newspaper advertisement that ended it. They had about given up hope when they finished an advertisement with an appeal to anyone who knew of a place similar to what they wanted, to let them know. One did.

Jim expects his annual level of production to hold close to 500,000 trout. Surrounded by all these fish, he has no time to take a pole and try to catch one in a lake or stream. But he doesn't care. "I've sort of lost interest in fishing," he says.

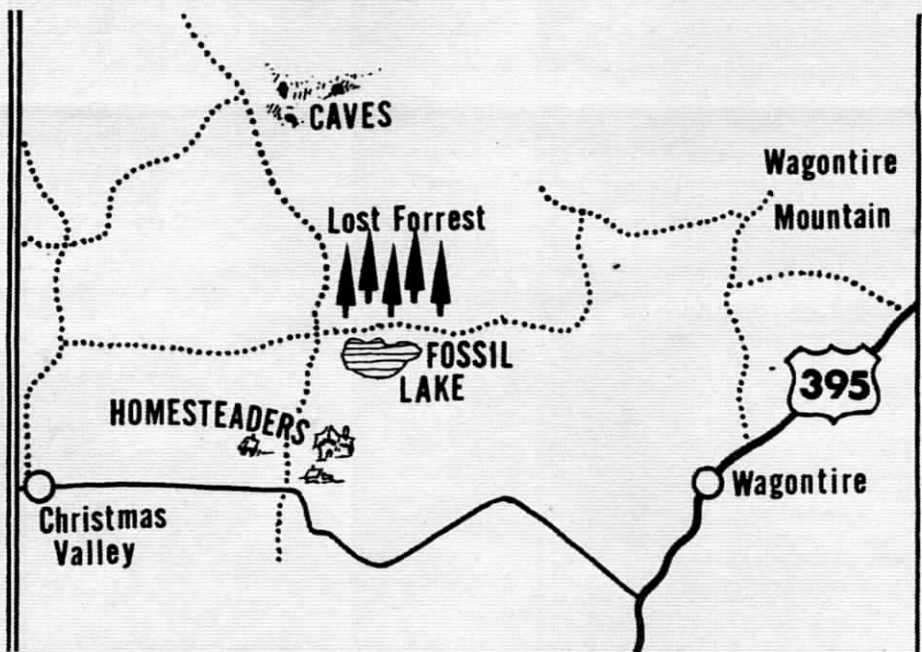
Grandfathers Are Nice People at Christmas Valley

Grandfathers really are nice people, say some of the little girls here at Christmas Valley.

"Mac" McClister bought a pony for his two little grandchildren, Sheila and Lori Hall, which their "big" Uncle Johnnie McClister, tried out for them. The pony's name is "Sunday."

Not to be outdone, Grandfather Frank Latner brought in two ponies, "Cinnamon and Ginger," for his two little granddaughters Cindy and Delores Hemett.

It is a good thing that all of the people here in Christmas Valley have large enough places for "pony grazing."



ERLE STANLEY GARDNER'S trip to Oregon Desert. The base camp was made at Lost Forrest, shown on map above. They explored as far South as Foley Creek and the ice caves.

SOFTBALL SUCCESS AT CHRISTMAS VALLEY

Christmas Valley had a softball team this year. In fact, two of them. Some really competitive games were played every Monday evening.

Bob Lloyd's team, the Pro Shop Pros, did win a few more games than Al Baert's Bums, but all in all they were pretty evenly matched.

FINAL SUMMARY

	R	H	E
Baert Bums	18	26	21
Pro Shop Pros	12	20	too many

Some evenings, one of the vacationers at Christmas Valley was called on to do the umpiring to keep everything "absolutely fair."

Next year should see some good ballplaying after this year's practice.

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